



P40 · 30 PAGES, PRINTABLE + FILLABLE

A Rainbow Baby Planner

A thirty-page planner for the pregnancy after a previous loss. Honors the loss without making this pregnancy about it. Covers the extra appointments, the trimester-by-trimester emotional weight, the anniversary handling, the telling-people decisions, and the page for when fear shows up in the middle of the night. With memorial pages that are optional. A partner page. The page that names the question no one wants to write down. And crisis lines at the back.

Soothemade Notes

A SMALL APOTHECARY OF PRINTABLES · MADE SLOWLY

A PLANNING AND TRACKING TOOL · NOT MEDICAL ADVICE

A note before you start

You are pregnant again. After.

After the loss, whichever kind it was. After the appointment where the room got quiet. After the day they sent you home with a number to call.

This pregnancy is happening in a body that remembers. The mind too. The mind is keeping a calendar against the previous calendar. The body is waiting for the day it stopped before. The phrase "I have a good feeling about this one" feels like a trap that has been set for you twice.

There is no part of this that is unreasonable.

This planner is for that experience. It is not a grief book. P20 Pregnancy Loss Gentle Companion is the grief book. This is the planner for the second story, the one running alongside.

You can use it for the whole pregnancy. You can use it for a season and then put it down. You can use it together with a regular pregnancy planner, the way two stories sit next to each other. You can put it in a drawer the day the baby comes home, or you can use it for the next pregnancy too. There is no right way.

With care, Maya

This is a planning and tracking tool, not medical advice. For specific medical questions about this pregnancy, please follow your obstetric provider's guidance. This planner does not name medications or recommend specific care, and it does not replace mental-health care for perinatal anxiety or trauma. Crisis lines are listed at the back.

How to use this planner

- The memorial pages are optional. You can skip them. You can keep them. You can fill them in later.
- The “anxiety in pregnancy after loss” page is worth reading early. Some patterns are useful to recognize before they are overwhelming.
- Each trimester has an emotional checkpoint page. The trimester of dread, the trimester of starting to hope, the trimester of almost.
- The “if it happens again” page is in the back. You do not have to read it. It is there because pretending the question is not there often makes the question louder. You can keep that page closed.
- Take what you want. Leave what you do not.

The previous loss

This page is for the loss to be acknowledged before the rest of the planner gets going. You do not have to fill it in.

THE PREVIOUS LOSS (or losses)

When: _____

How far along: _____

Names, if there are names:

What I want to remember about that pregnancy:

What I want this pregnancy to know:

Memorial page one

Optional. For words to or about the previous pregnancy. You can leave it blank. You can use it for a small letter. You can paste in an ultrasound. You can write a name down for the first time.

Memorial page two

Optional. A second one in case you want to come back to this later in the pregnancy.

DATE: _____

[illegible]

Memorial page three

Optional. A third one, in case the loss surfaces later in the pregnancy in a way that needs writing down.

DATE: _____

[illegible]

Anxiety in pregnancy after loss, what is common

This page lists common patterns. It is not prescribing how to manage them. It is naming them so you can recognize them in yourself.

Anniversary anxiety. Around the week the previous loss happened, anxiety often spikes. Even if this pregnancy is doing fine. Even if your provider is reassuring. The body is on a calendar.

Symptom-checking. Many rainbow parents check for symptoms (or absence of symptoms) constantly. Every cramp. Every bathroom trip. Every change in nausea. This is the body trying to hold control where it cannot have it.

Appointment fear. The 24 hours before an appointment is often the hardest. The hour after is often relief, sometimes followed by guilt or numbness.

Bonding fear. Many rainbow parents do not allow themselves to attach to this pregnancy until late. The fear of loss is loud. This is normal. Bonding can happen at any pace. It does not predict the outcome.

Hyperarousal. Trouble sleeping. Easily startled. Catastrophic thoughts. These are common after pregnancy loss, and they are also signs of perinatal anxiety.

Avoidance. Some rainbow parents do not look at baby clothes. Do not let people throw a shower. Do not pack a hospital bag until very late. This is the body protecting itself.

Reassurance-seeking. Calling the doctor's office repeatedly. Buying a home doppler and using it many times a day. Asking your partner the same question many times. The reassurance does not stay.

What I am noticing in myself, right now:

- ☐ Anniversary anxiety
- ☐ Symptom-checking
- ☐ Appointment fear
- ☐ Bonding fear
- ☐ Hyperarousal
- ☐ Avoidance
- ☐ Reassurance-seeking
- ☐ Other: _____

How much it is interfering with my day-to-day:

- ☐ A little
- ☐ Some
- ☐ A lot
- ☐ I cannot function around it

WHEN TO GET SUPPORT (call your provider or a perinatal therapist):

- ☐ You cannot function for hours at a time
- ☐ You cannot eat or sleep
- ☐ You are having intrusive thoughts about loss every day
- ☐ You are isolating from people who love you
- ☐ Your gut is telling you you need help

THE THERAPIST OR LINE I AM RESERVING THE NUMBER FOR, IN ADVANCE:

You do not have to "earn" the help by being worse. Pregnancy after loss is one of the most well-documented times to seek perinatal mental-health care. It is preventive, not weak.

Extra appointments tracker

Many providers see rainbow parents more often than parents without prior loss. The reasons vary. Some are clinical (the previous loss prompted closer monitoring). Some are emotional (the provider knows what you are carrying).

APPOINTMENT 1 DATE: _____

What they checked:

What they said:

What I felt walking out:

APPOINTMENT 2 DATE: _____

What they checked:

What they said:

What I felt walking out:

APPOINTMENT 3 DATE: _____

What they checked:

What they said:

What I felt walking out:

APPOINTMENT 4 DATE: _____

What they checked:

What they said:

What I felt walking out:

APPOINTMENT 5

DATE:

What they checked:

What they said:

What I felt walking out:

APPOINTMENT 6

DATE:

What they checked:

What they said:

What I felt walking out:

Trimester one, the trimester of dread

For most rainbow parents, the first trimester is the loudest. The previous loss happened in the first trimester for many. Every cramp is a memory. Every appointment is the appointment.

WHAT I AM CARRYING THIS TRIMESTER

The fear that is loudest:

The thing I am doing to manage it (whatever it is, no judgment):

What is helping (people, places, practices):

What is not helping:

THE FIRST APPOINTMENT THIS TIME

Date: _____

What I asked them to do differently (if anything) because of the prior loss:

What they said about my history:

A REMINDER FOR THIS TRIMESTER

Your body is doing what bodies do. Most of what happens in early pregnancy that is not normal is not something you can detect or prevent. The provider is the one watching for signs. You are allowed to call them when you are scared, even if there are no signs. That is what they are for.

You are allowed to not be excited yet. You are allowed to feel nothing some days. You are allowed to grieve in this pregnancy.

A pregnancy after loss is not betraying the previous baby.
It is its own pregnancy. They are not in competition.

Trimester two, the trimester of starting to hope

For some rainbow parents, the second trimester quiets a little. The anatomy scan brings new information. Some begin to imagine the baby. Many do not yet. Both are okay.

WHAT HAS SHIFTED SINCE THE FIRST TRIMESTER

WHAT IS THE SAME

THE ANATOMY SCAN

Date: _____

How I prepared (sometimes specific preparation is needed):

What they told me:

How I felt after:

STARTING TO HOPE

The first thing I let myself imagine this trimester:

The thing I cannot yet let myself imagine:

What I want to say to myself the day I am ready:

A NOTE

Some rainbow parents start to bond around now. Some do not. The timing of bonding does not predict the outcome. Take whatever pace your nervous system is offering.

Trimester three, the trimester of almost

For most rainbow parents, the third trimester carries a different weight. The pregnancy is past the gestational age of the previous loss (for most rainbow parents). The body is growing into delivery. The mind is sometimes still bracing.

WHERE I AM, ENTERING THE THIRD TRIMESTER

THE FEAR THAT IS LOUDEST RIGHT NOW

WHAT I AM PRACTICALLY PREPARING (or not preparing yet)

- ☐ Nursery
- ☐ Hospital bag
- ☐ Pediatrician selected
- ☐ Going-home outfit
- ☐ Birth-plan thinking
- ☐ Help schedule for the first weeks home
- ☐ Other: _____
- ☐ Nothing yet, and that is okay

THE DAY I LET MYSELF BUY THE FIRST THING WAS:

A NOTE FOR THE LAST WEEKS

The fear can be loud in the final stretch. Some rainbow parents request additional monitoring or non-stress tests in the third trimester. Your provider can tell you what makes sense for your specific pregnancy.

You do not have to wait for the provider to bring it up.
You can ask.

What I want to ask my provider about late-pregnancy monitoring:

Anniversary handling

The anniversary of the previous loss often arrives during this pregnancy. Sometimes more than once. The week the loss began. The week the diagnosis came. The day the procedure was done. The estimated due date.

THE ANNIVERSARIES ON MY CALENDAR

1. _____ (what: _____)
2. _____ (what: _____)
3. _____ (what: _____)
4. _____ (what: _____)

THE ONE THAT FALLS DURING THIS PREGNANCY THAT I AM MOST SCARED OF:

WHAT I WANT TO DO ON THAT DAY (or week)

- ☐ Take the day off if I can
- ☐ Be with one specific person: _____
- ☐ Plant or buy something for the previous baby
- ☐ Light a candle
- ☐ Take a walk in a specific place
- ☐ Talk to the previous baby
- ☐ See my therapist that day
- ☐ Tell my partner that I need them present
- ☐ Other: _____
- ☐ Pretend it is a normal day (also an option)

WHAT I WANT MY PARTNER OR SUPPORT PERSON TO KNOW

A note: anniversaries can hit even when you forget the date is coming. The body sometimes knows before the mind. If you are suddenly heavy a few days before an anniversary, check the calendar. It might be that.

Telling people about this pregnancy

Telling people the second time is often harder than the first time. The first time, you assumed it would be fine. The second time, you know what “not fine” looks like.

WHO I HAVE TOLD, AND WHEN

WHO I HAVE NOT TOLD, BY CHOICE

THE PEOPLE WHO KNOW ABOUT THE PREVIOUS LOSS BUT NOT THIS PREGNANCY

THE PEOPLE WHO DO NOT KNOW ABOUT THE PREVIOUS LOSS

WHAT I AM TELLING THE PEOPLE WHO ASK PROBING QUESTIONS

Script 1: "I'm not sharing yet. I will when I am ready."

Script 2: "We are taking it slow. Thank you for understanding."

Script 3: "I appreciate you asking. I do not have an update."

You do not owe anyone the timing of when you share.

You do not owe anyone the history of your previous pregnancies.

WHAT I WANT THE WORLD TO KNOW (eventually, on my timing)

When fear shows up

It will. This page is what to reach for in the middle of the night, when the body is sure something is wrong.

First, the body checks. Are you in pain that is unusual. Is there bleeding that is heavy. Is there a change that warrants a call.

If yes, call your provider. The on-call line exists for this.

If no, the next thing is grounding.

Grounding for the middle of the night:

- Sit up. Put your feet on the floor. Feel the cold.
- Name five things you can see in the room.
- Name four things you can touch.
- Name three things you can hear.
- Name two things you can smell.
- Name one thing you can taste.
- Drink a glass of water.
- Wake the partner if you need to.

A small mantra that some rainbow parents use:

- "Right now, in this exact moment, the baby is okay."

You do not have to know what will happen tomorrow. You only have to be okay in this exact moment. Sometimes that is one minute at a time.

MY MIDDLE-OF-THE-NIGHT PLAN

Who I will wake if I need to: _____

The number I will call if it is bigger than waking someone:

The thing my therapist or doula told me to do when this happens:

The mantra that works for me:

Partner page

For the support person. The previous loss happened in two lives. So is this pregnancy.

The grief from before is sometimes asymmetric. Sometimes the partner who did not carry the previous baby is also carrying significant grief. Sometimes the partner is more okay than the pregnant person. Sometimes the other way. Sometimes neither of you can talk about it without it getting fractious.

WHAT THIS PREGNANCY IS ASKING OF THE SUPPORT PERSON

DURING APPOINTMENTS

- ☐ Be there. Most rainbow parents need a body in the room.
- ☐ Watch your person, not just the monitor.
- ☐ Ask the question your person was too scared to ask.
- ☐ Take notes. The pregnant person may not remember the conversation after.

AT HOME

- ☐ Do not say "this pregnancy is different" as a reassurance to your partner. They know it is different. The fear is not about logic.
- ☐ Do not say "everything will be fine." You do not know that. Saying it makes them feel alone with the fear.
- ☐ Do say "I am here. We are doing this together. Whichever way it goes, we are still us."
- ☐ Watch for the anniversary dates. Mark them on the calendar.
- ☐ Bring up the previous baby when it feels right. Not bringing them up at all sometimes feels like erasure.

YOUR OWN GRIEF

This pregnancy may surface your own grief about the previous loss in new ways. That is real. The grief is not a competition between the two of you. Both of you carry it.

If you need your own therapist, that is allowed. Many partners of rainbow parents see one.

The “what if it happens again” page

This is the page no one wants to write down. The planner is doing it because pretending it is not in the room often makes it louder.

You are pregnant. The previous loss happened. The possibility of another loss is in the room, no matter how unlikely your provider says it is for your specific pregnancy.

This page is not about probability. It is about the planning that some rainbow parents quietly do, in case.

WHAT I WANT IN PLACE, IN CASE

This is not pessimism. This is not "manifesting." This is one of the few real ways to hold the possibility without it owning you.

THE PERSON I WANT TO CALL FIRST IF SOMETHING CHANGES

THE PROVIDER LINE TO CALL

THE THERAPIST I HAVE ALREADY RESERVED FOR IF NEEDED

(If you do not have one yet, getting one now is one of the kindest things you can do for the future self who might need them. You can always not use the appointment.)

THE PEOPLE WHO ALREADY KNOW MY HISTORY AND WHO I COULD ASK FOR HELP WITHOUT EXPLAINING

P20 PREGNANCY LOSS GENTLE COMPANION IS ON MY SHELF, AT THE READY

- ☐ Yes (I bought it preventively)
- ☐ No, and I do not want it (also valid)
- ☐ I will buy it if I need it

WHAT I WANT TO REMEMBER, FROM THIS PREGNANCY, NO MATTER WHAT HAPPENS

You can close this page now. You wrote it. It is held. You do not have to look at it again unless you need to.

Crisis lines

If thoughts of harm to yourself or to the baby are present, call.

United States:

- 988, Suicide and Crisis Lifeline (call or text)
- 1-833-852-6262 (PSI), Postpartum Support International HelpLine
- 1-800-944-4773, PSI HelpLine, alternate number

United Kingdom:

- 116 123, Samaritans
- 0808 1640 8888, Tommy's Pregnancy Loss Helpline

Canada:

- 9-8-8, Suicide Crisis Helpline (call or text)
- 1-833-456-4566, Canada Suicide Prevention Service

Your country has a number even if it is not here. Search "crisis line [your country]." Save the number now, before you need it.

A note: pregnancy loss and pregnancy-after-loss are widely supported in perinatal mental-health communities. You are not alone, even when the room feels empty.

A final letter

You are doing something hard.

You are pregnant in a body that remembers. You are showing up for appointments that cost you something. You are eating, sleeping, working, parenting (sometimes) other children, while a part of you holds your breath for nine months.

Whichever way this pregnancy ends, you did the work. The carrying. The hoping. The making of the small space for this baby that exists alongside the small space you have made for the previous one.

If this pregnancy delivers, that baby is not a replacement. They are their own person. They will know, eventually, that they have a sibling who came first. You will figure out when and how to tell them.

If this pregnancy does not deliver, you carried again. That is its own act of courage. The grief is layered. The community for this exists, and you are not the only person who has done this twice or more.

You are not crazy. You are not selfish. You are not “being too much.” You are pregnant after loss. This is what it is.

Whatever you write in this planner, or do not write, is yours.

With care, Maya



Soothemade *Notes*

*Made for the version of you no one tells you about, the
one at four in the morning, the one in the parking lot, the
one who doesn't recognize her own week.*

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